A Note on Our Bad
by Rachel Ossip

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“WHY I SABOTAGED YOUR PROPERTY.” An essay on spectacular explosions and subtle slowdowns, weaponized beans and weaponized incompetence.

In September 2022, *How to Blow Up a Pipeline* debuted at the Toronto International Film Festival to critical acclaim. The Soderbergh-esque thriller follows eight young people, strategically varied in gender, race, and class background, as they struggle with losses and traumas traceable to the fossil-fuel industry. After they've had enough of arguments for market-based solutions and incremental change, two university students decide to go "outside of the system" and "start attacking the things that are killing us." Using their network of childhood friends, summer internships, social media accounts, and alternative bookshops, they assemble an eclectic collective to pull off some targeted property damage: blowing up an oil pipeline in West Texas.

The film's opening shot follows a young woman in a pale red jacket and hoodie as she walks down the sidewalk to an ominous, droning soundtrack. She unsheathes a knife, glances up and down the street, then leans down to stab ... the tires of an SUV. As a final gesture, she places a bright yellow flyer that declares WHY I SABOTAGED YOUR PROPERTY on the vehicle's dashboard. The scene is inspired by activist groups like the Tyre Extinguishers, an anonymous, leaderless collective whose members traverse major metropolises wedging green lentils in the tire valves of luxury SUVs. The gleam of the knife may make for a more persuasive and pulse-accelerating opening sequence, but the lentil is more elegant: almost undetectable, probably untraceable, nearly passable as an accident—though, of course, the flyer declares the saboteur's intent.

The film is an adaptation of the activist and scholar Andreas Malm's *How to Blow Up a Pipeline: Learning to Fight in a World on Fire* (2021),which includes a parallel sequence featuring Malm as the tire-destroying protagonist. Equipped with weaponized mung beans, he trawls the streets after dark with a group of fellow Swedes as they search for SUVs to incapacitate. Malm concedes that deflating the tires of the rich was "direct action as prank, perhaps too jolly and tender to deserve the term 'sabotage.'" Nonetheless, he weaves the temporary disabling of gas guzzlers into a broader narrative of the "long and venerable tradition of sabotaging fossil-fuel infrastructure," which ranges from the Popular Front for the

Liberation of Palestine to the South African anti-apartheid resistance, from the Houthi rebellion to the American civil rights movement. Given the rich history of freedom fighters turning to property destruction, as well as the recent surge of public enthusiasm for pipeline protests led by Native groups, Malm asks why there have been so few direct assaults on the machinery of carbon capitalism by climate activists.

In the United States, one answer might be the FBI's fixation on "eco-terrorism," which the agency treated as the "no. 1 domestic terrorism threat" in the 2000s. The FBI frequently used anti-terrorism laws to target environmental activists, and "terrorism enhancements" to extend their prison sentences once convicted. Regardless of that obvious suppression, Malm argues that the climate movement has overinvested in pacifism and feel-good pageantry while denouncing and underinvesting in the strategic destruction that would be necessary to truly move the needle. Activists have too fully accepted the idea that marches and sit-ins are more likely than violence (even if only against property) to usher in social and political transformation. Malm asserts that large-scale change requires a radical flank, which shifts the demands of more conciliatory actors into an agreeable light. The film adaptation of *How to Blow Up a Pipeline* ventriloquizes these arguments through the mouths of plausibly hip twenty-somethings, while providing a nearly step-by-step guide to taking a targeted swing at fossil-fuel infrastructure.

Adapting a pop-academic book into an action flick is an odd move–odd enough that the project seems to have originated as a joke among the screenwriters about the absurdity of such an endeavor. I saw the film at a preview screening without much foreknowledge and, having read Malm's book, anticipated a documentary rather than a "fiercely watchable thriller," to quote the *Guardian*. I stifled laughs through scenes that I don't think were intentionally played for humor, particularly a wink-and-nod sequence in which the bleach-blond bad boy Logan spots his future comrade Shawn flipping through Malm's manifesto in a bookstore. "That's got some good shit," Logan remarks with a sly

smile."Doesn't teach you how to do it, though." (For better or worse, the only destructive gesture Malm actually explains is how to deflate a tire with beans.) After the explosion of the pipeline, the film ends with a brief scene in which newly inspired climate defenders, also in hoodies, blow up a luxury yacht. Before planting the bomb, these revolutionaries staple another bright yellow WHY I SABOTAGED YOUR PROPERTY flyer to the nearby dock. Sabotage inspires sabotage, the film suggests, and could ignite a chain of action that saves us from ecological collapse. All we have to do is start blowing things up (conscientiously, of course).

Whether on those bright yellow flyers, the lips of the film's characters, or the pages of Malm's book, *sabotage* appears frequently in the universe of *How to Blow Up a Pipeline*. Malm deploys the word straightforwardly, as "a synonym for the damage and destruction of property." While acts of sabotage can certainly involve the destruction of property, conflating the terms risks losing a wealth of connotation and history. Rather than synonyms, sabotage and property destruction are overlapping circles in a Venn diagram; not all property destruction is sabotage, and not all sabotage involves property destruction. That said, I sympathize with Malm's decision to provide such a pat definition: pinning down exactly what sabotage *does* mean is tricky, given how broadly the term is used and how fervently its definition has been debated.

Today, sabotage is often treated as a synonym for *undermine*, cropping up in self-help seminars, reality-TV accounts of romantic betrayal, and listicles on "The 10 Workout Mistakes Holding You Back." In the heyday of industrial labor movements, though, sabotage was a novel and potent term, used by American activists and pamphleteers like Elizabeth Gurley Flynn to describe the "withdrawal of efficiency" by workers—a form of striking on the job without sacrificing wages. Sabotage did not necessarily require disabling machinery, let alone destroying anything. According to the French anarcho-syndicalist Émile Pouget, who published one of the most well-known treatises on sabotage in 1898 and helped to popularize the term in Europe, workers in France learned the tactic from the British, who had been inspired by dockhands in Glasgow.

After farmers were hired to bust their strike, the dockhands went back to work but mimicked the unskilled scabs' sluggish and clumsy labor—a strategy they called *ca' canny*, or "go canny," meaning "take care" or "go slow." Gurley Flynn followed this example with an apocryphal tale of a railroad worker who similarly tempered the quality of his shoveling to the pay, giving his employer the option to increase his daily rate in exchange for greater speed: a dollar a day bought a "leisurely" pace, while two dollars was "a hummer."

In 2022, American media fixated on the newly named phenomenon of "quiet quitting": the trend of reducing one's labor at work to the bare minimum, rejecting the above-and-beyond mentality of hustle culture. Disillusioned with the ever-shifting goal posts of the supposed meritocracy, Gen Z workers in particular decided to give the boss only their labor, rather than their heart and soul. At the time, a Gallup poll claimed that more than half of American workers were quiet quitters. However, as Derek Thompson points out in the *Atlantic*, the phrase was more accurate in signaling anxieties around the erosion of work-life boundaries than actual decreases in efficiency. Still, quiet quitting emerged as a new term for on-the-job protests, as if the strategy were something novel. But quiet quitting is just ca' canny by another name—as much sabotage as blowing up a pipeline.

Nevertheless, bringing up sabotage in mixed company often evokes youthful revolutionaries wielding explosives—an image *How to Blow Up a Pipeline*, of course, reinforces. When I floated the idea for an issue of Triple Canopy on the topic to an esteemed writer in her seventies, someone who typically encourages radical expressions of dissent, she went straight to the Vietnam War, when the CIA sent South Vietnamese combat teams across the border on "sabotage missions." She worried that even addressing sabotage would be perceived as calling for violence. Malm, for his part, spends a fair amount of time differentiating his version of sabotage—property destruction that, ideally, avoids physical harm to people—from terrorism. But it's difficult to push back against the word's associations with spectacular detonations and radical insurgency, given how flash and gore stick in the mind and stoke fear in the

media. Bombs and carnage are hard to forget. Meanwhile, insurance companies like Talbot AIG continue to clump "Terrorism & Sabotage" together in a single area of coverage, describing both acts as an "ever-present threat that can be difficult to predict and quantify."[1] Curiously, this definition emphasizes the psychological elements of the tactic, hinting that the most potent acts of sabotage may only ever exist as the mere suggestion of a threat.

BEWARE

GOOD PAY OR BUM WORK

I.W.W.



ONE BIG UNION

WE NEVER FORGET

SABOTAGE

In the United States, the link between sabotage and property damage has plagued the political imaginary since the early twentieth century, when fierce debates over the tactic raged in leftist and labor organizations. At the heart of these debates was the Industrial Workers of the World (IWW, a.k.a. the Wobblies), sabotage's most vocal early champion. This "one big union" of syndicalists sought revolution through the control of industry, organizing across sectors, races, religions, and genders, with a focus on laborers who weren't represented by more traditional unions, such as migrants, domestic workers, and telephone operators. The IWW was inspired by French syndicalists like Pouget, whose tactics were carried to the US, in part, by Italian and Spanish immigrants. Compared to the American Federation of Labor or the Socialist Party of America, the IWW was a young, militant upstart, though the organization was less interested in armed struggle than the Marxists and outright anarchists. IWW doctrine taught that capitalists are thieves, stealing wealth from the workers who so clearly produce it. All that remains is to take possession of the means of production through whatever means are most expedient—and, in the meantime, fight for better wages and conditions.

The IWW's strategy focused on traditional strikes, but also incorporated an expansive menu of tactics, sabotage among them. While sabotage did not explicitly preclude property destruction, the Wobblies drew a clear and bright line between violence against persons and violence against objects and infrastructure. The Wobbly leader and writer Walker C. Smith emphasized that sabotage was itself a form of creative nonviolence, which "places human life ... higher than all else in the universe." But members of the bourgeoisie, even middle-class and intellectual socialists, felt threatened by the IWW's militant messaging and tactics. Conflating this new, strange word with violence and individualism—and promoting the image of the saboteur as an anarchist with a bomb in hand—proved to be useful in discrediting the IWW.

By the early 1910s, factionalism was swelling within the Socialist Party of America, and middle-class reformists sought to distance themselves from the radicalism of the "slum proletariat" in

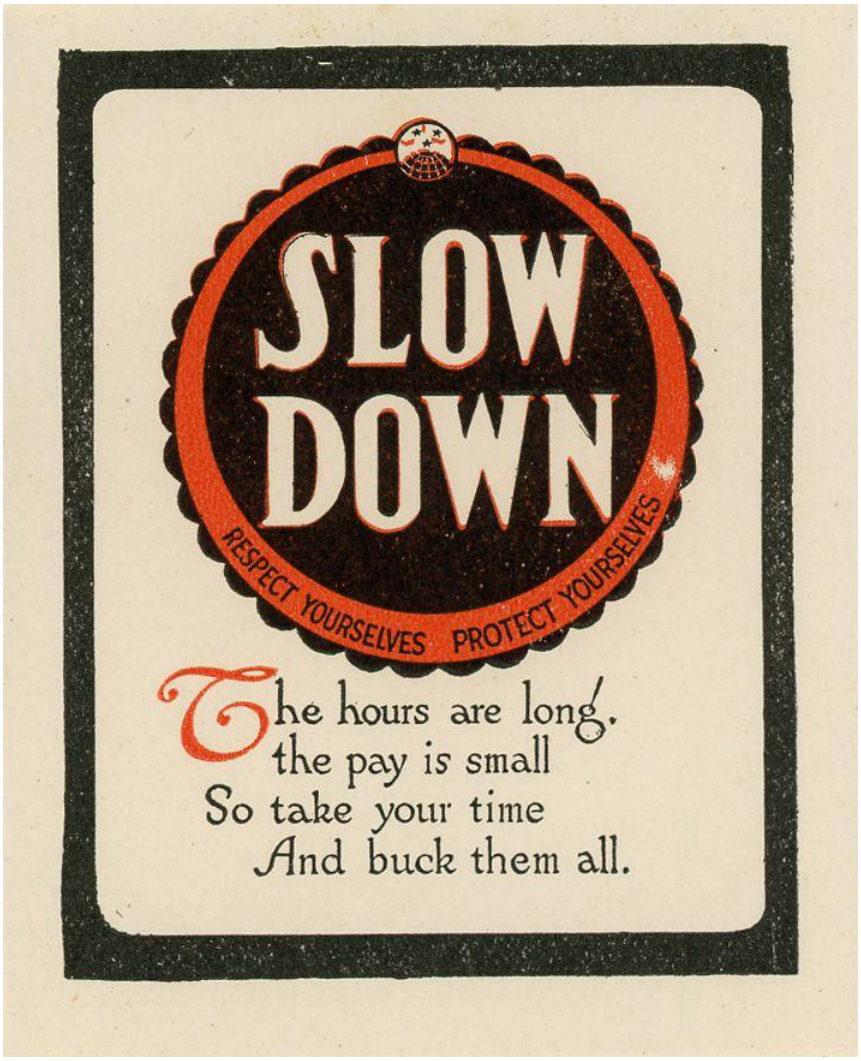
order to solidify the inroads they'd made in elections. The reformists succeeded in demonizing sabotage as a "method of violence"—and, with help from the press, recasting the Wobblies as dangerous thugs, while likely never understanding the term's full meaning.[1] Even John Spargo, a prominent right-wing Party member and opponent of sabotage, recognized that the term's adversaries had trouble defining—and even saying—this "new and strange" word. "Some pronounced it 'Säbbatige,' others 'sābbotage' and still others 'sabotaj,'" he wrote. Those who made an attempt claimed that sabotage meant "putting the boots to the boss," or working slowly and poorly enough "at the machine" to drain profits and force the boss "to come around and ask, 'What is wrong; what can I do to satisfy you people?'"

Yet sabotage has never been restricted to the shop floor. Spargo tells of barbers in Paris responding to a failed strike by throwing staining potassium at the painted fronts of barbershops each night, causing the proprietors to repaint them over and over again—a form of strategic graffiti that, in many cases, resulted in successfully negotiating better wages. He suggests that service workers who have direct contact with customers could deploy *La bouche ouvert*, or open-mouthed sabotage, whether to frighten patrons by revealing the poor conditions in restaurant kitchens or empower them by sharing the recipes for mixing expensive medicines. Alternatively, clerks could simply undercharge customers for expensive items. Of course, Spargo also mentions the slowdown, as well as a related method, known today as "work to rule," in which workers follow procedures or protocols so precisely as to cause chaos or, at least, innumerable delays. He recounts Italian railway workers who, "with fine Italian cunning, suddenly became very 'good,' and 'law-abiding.' ... Every rule was most scrupulously obeyed, for the first time in history." As a result, the entire train line drew to a crawl.

The pamphlets and debates concerning sabotage from that time are full of such anecdotes, proving Pouget's earlier claim that "to list out the thousand methods and ways of sabotage would be an endless rosary." Writers consistently make clear that the word was not coined to name a new tactic but to label an ever-present,

intuitive impulse to use cunning and wit in the face of oppression. Another socialist party member, Frank Bohn, notes that "slaves in the South practiced [sabotage] regularly by putting stones and dirt in their bags of cotton to make them weigh heavier." What was codified, then, was less of a specific method than the act of following this impulse—"a principle of action capable of an almost infinite variety of applications," to quote Spargo again. "It may be based on illegal acts or it may not. It may consist of telling lies or of telling the simple truth."

Gurley Flynn, who was committed to the IWW in her early life, also wrote of sabotage's expansive and shifting nature: It is "as broad and changing as industry, as flexible as the imagination and passions of humanity. Every day working-men and women are discovering new forms." Corralling these organic, creative forms of resistance under one name enabled advocates to explicitly call for and teach sabotage, yet also made it easier for critics to condemn the act. The term's breadth ensured that sabotage would remain elastic and adaptable, but also slippery, primed for misunderstanding, reinterpretation, and perversion. Today, few hear *sabotage* and think of anything like ca' canny.


SLOW
DOWN
RESPECT YOURSELVES PROTECT YOURSELVES
The hours are long.
the pay is small
So take your time
And buck them all.

One of the many concerns raised by sabotage's critics in the 1910s was that those who learned it might learn it all too well, applying this "principle of action" outside of the workplace. Of course, this was true. Sabotage could be used nearly anywhere, by anyone. In parallel to the extensive history of sabotage in labor struggles, similar tactics had long been employed by capitalists, who regularly restricted production to increase demand and profit, destroyed surplus goods to avoid price drops, and designed products to fail over time. From the outset, pamphleteers like Gurley Flynn and William E. Trautmann highlighted the prevalence of "capitalist sabotage," noting the use of dye additives that caused silk gowns to crumble over time and cheap, rotting eggs in cakes sold to the poor. Now, capitalist sabotage also looks like products with features designed to rely on an unrelated, recurring purchase, as illustrated by the recent class action suit against Canon, in which plaintiffs assert that the Pixma MG6320 "All-in-One" printer won't even scan or fax when it's out of (expensive) ink. Yet it's rare that such actions are deemed sabotage, rather than innovative product design.

In his short tract *On the Nature and Uses of Sabotage* (1919), the economist Thorstein Veblen argued that making any reasonable profit within a price system requires sabotage—or, at least, sabotage-like restrictions of production. Efforts by captains of industry to limit production or otherwise control the market are motivated by "a view to the largest obtainable net profit" rather than to "the physical needs" of the community, and so adulteration and suppressing outputs are the norm. Nowhere is this more apparent today than in the American markets for pharmaceuticals and health care, where monopolies perpetuated by "junk" patents block generic drug production, and anti-competition schemes fueled by private equity drive up prices. In *Sabotage: The Hidden Nature of Finance* (2020), Anastasia Nesvetailova and Ronen Palan pick up Veblen's thread to claim that sabotage is "the main source of profitability in finance and the surest way to individual bonuses and corporate profits." Markets, they argue, naturally hit a low-profit equilibrium, so financiers rely on quasi-monopolization, dubious financial "innovations," and the careful navigation of loopholes to

make the big bucks. But who imagines a Wall Street suit when they hear *saboteur*?

Like *sabotage* and *violence*, *property destruction* is typically used to describe the transgressive actions of activists and not the more common and vast range of destruction caused by industry. As the scholar R. H. Lossin observes, "Oil leaks, wild fires, failed crops, and dead fisheries caused by corporate pollution are rarely called what they are: property destruction." Fossil-fuel executives play off ecological devastation as unfortunate mistakes with unintended consequences, just as finance bros apologize and feign shock over supposedly unexpected client losses. Yet if these "accidents" occur often enough, one has to think they're willful—the accrual of destructive mishaps indicates a lack of interest in avoiding catastrophic outcomes.

This disinterest is a form of "weaponized incompetence": claiming to be incapable or unaware in order to evade responsibility, or performing tasks poorly with hopes of getting out of them. Like quiet quitting, it's a zeitgeisty contemporary phrase that rhymes with the initial sense of sabotage. Ca' canny involved not only slowing down but feigning clumsiness, acting like an untrained scab rather than a seasoned dockworker. As Evan Calder Williams observes in his essay for this issue, part of the power of sabotage—for both the owning and the working class—comes not only from working badly, but from the difficulty of discerning if and when someone is doing so willfully. Or, as Elon Musk put it in a tweet in May 2023: "Incompetence, in the limit, is indistinguishable from sabotage."

Musk is such an active shitposter that it's hard to tell if his tweet was meant to refer to anything specific, though paranoia over sabotage seems to drive his management strategies. Several months before, Musk had fired thousands of staffers at the platform then known as Twitter and placed a temporary freeze on the remaining employees' ability to write and roll out code, ostensibly for fear of sabotage. In 2018, he reported that a Tesla employee had made "direct code changes to the Tesla Manufacturing Operating System under false usernames and exported large amounts of highly

sensitive Tesla data to unknown third parties"; he also suggested that a minor assembly-line fire was due to "suspicious activity," possibly spurred by outside forces—"Wall Street short sellers," oil and gas companies, rival automakers—that were trying to take Tesla down. But the tweet also signals the possibility that Musk has weaponized his own incompetence. Some have argued that his nonsensical, damaging changes to X (f.k.a. Twitter) point to intentional destruction rather than poor management, a deliberate dismantling of what he has called "the global town square." Whether Musk has operated primarily as a venture-capitalist disruptor or a capitalist saboteur—or if there's a meaningful distinction between the two—may be in the eye of the beholder.

Earlier in 2023, Musk had shared an excerpt of the "Simple Sabotage Field Manual," accompanied by the caption "How to sabotage an organization." Published in 1944 by the CIA's predecessor, the Office of Strategic Services (OSS), the manual indicates how to motivate ordinary "citizen-saboteurs" in Europe to assist the Allied efforts. The agency distinguishes between the "highly technical" acts of sabotage undertaken by "specially trained operatives" with detailed plans, and this more pedestrian variety, which encompasses "innumerable simple acts" carried out with "a minimum danger of injury, detection, and reprisal." Rather than bombs, the citizen-saboteur's weapons are "salt, nails, candles, pebbles, thread"; "faulty decisions" or a "non-cooperative attitude"; and "engaging in bickerings or displaying surliness and stupidity."

While the manual aims to instigate efforts to debilitate and weaken enemy forces, the OSS also illustrated how many kinds of sabotage are not simply physical but improvisational, nonviolent, psychological, and social. The document guides saboteurs to attack the enemy with "speeches" and conversations about "irrelevant issues," and to "talk as frequently as possible and at great length," illustrating "your 'points' by long anecdotes and accounts of personal experiences," peppered with "'patriotic' comments." Wasting time is a prized strategy, and the pamphlet suggests that the saboteur will become an expert at doing so after adopting a novel perspective: "all sorts of weapons will present themselves"

when the saboteur begins to see tools, systems, processes, and water-cooler conversations not as serving the intended purpose but as potential forces of dysfunction and disorientation.

DON'T SCAB

JOIN THE UNION OF YOUR CLASS
THE I.W.W

Whenever you speed up or work
long hours on the job, you
are scabbing on the
unemployed

FOR INFORMATION ADDRESS I W W., 1001 W MADISON ST. CHICAGO, ILL., U S A

On November 8, 2023, a brief article was published on Indybay, the website for the San Francisco Bay Area Independent Media Center, providing explicit instructions on how to dismantle a building's water main by filling the pipe with concrete. The specific building targeted—the Hiller Aviation Museum in San Carlos, California—had been in the midst of hosting a gala for the philanthropic organization known as the Friends of the Israeli Defense Forces, a US-based nonprofit that fundraises for Israel's military. When the anonymous communiqué appeared, public opinion of US support for Israel was plummeting and protests clogged the streets of major cities. The guide interweaves the practicalities of mixing concrete with a salvo against Israel's genocidal assault on Palestinians. The "autonomous anti-Zionists and anarchist saboteurs" who penned the document were inspired by the IDF's own tactics: through the years, the Israeli military has asserted control of water in Palestine, "cutting off Palestinian access to the Jordan River … shooting holes in Palestinian water towers, bombing Gazan water treatment facilities, poisoning Palestinian springs."

While *sabotage* was coined by workers, the act belongs to both the occupied and the occupiers, those in power and those in the resistance. The powerful may seem, at the moment, to have a monopoly on sabotage and similar methods of disruption and disorientation, as well as the means of deterring the powerless from adopting the same strategies, whether with threats of incarceration or other forms of punishment. And so long as sabotage means blowing up pipelines, it'll continue to be regarded as an extreme measure—one that is necessary, perhaps, but available only to the brave or foolish, to those willing or able to do jail time. But, as Gurley Flynn notes, new forms of sabotage are discovered every day.

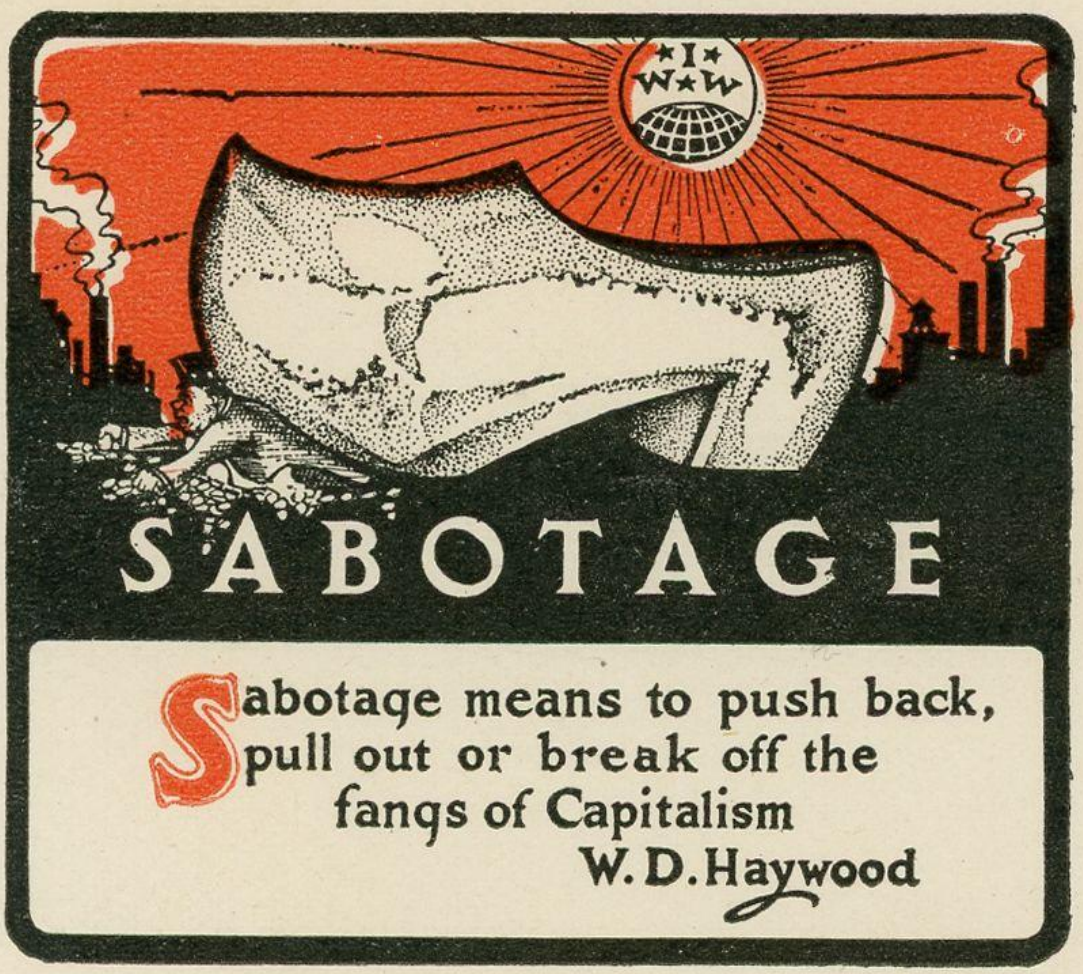
This issue of Triple Canopy asks what we might discover or invent when we delve into the "endless rosary" of sabotage, whether that involves filling water tanks with concrete, speechifying in staff meetings, or loosing orchestras of crickets on police recruitment events. The slowdown, for instance, dramatizes the value of skilled labor (and brings the boss to the negotiating table), but also provides an opportunity to look around—to analyze our

surroundings, which otherwise tend to blur given the pace of work and deficiency of time. As the OSS manual points out, seeing the world through the lens of sabotage reveals the environments and processes that constrain our lives to be armories of commonplace "weapons." With that in mind, we've invited artists, writers, researchers, designers, and organizers to engage with sabotage as a perspective and principle of action, addressing seductive, explosive spectacles alongside comparatively subtle forms of subversion. But the issue goes beyond sabotage to sketch out a constellation of acts that also serve as methods of analysis (or vice versa), emphasizing the difference between such forms of dissidence. Some of the contributors are concerned with the power of slowdowns or acts of mischief that manifest as technical errors; others are set on infiltrating professions, institutions, markets, or milieux in order to study and destabilize them.

We're interested in the conditions that cause people to search for agency, leverage, and camaraderie in acts of subterfuge and trickery. What motivates and enables them to stall the operations of a profiteering company, counteract the design of a dehumanizing mechanism, or inventively manipulate loopholes that are generally used to liberate the wealthy from law? And what might these acts teach us about the systems being disrupted? We're especially intent on turning sabotage's lens toward the realms of art and culture, where labor is so often obscured by the fantasy of "creativity," and criticisms of unjust structures are used to gild commodities with a sense of virtuous subversion. What changes if we see the privileged status of art as a loophole to be exploited not only by plutocrats evading taxes, but by artists operating facades, redistributing resources, and manipulating organizations? In an age of breakneck media production and endless scroll, spurred by click-starved advertisers and algorithmic scabs, the culture industry might benefit from a dose of ca' canny.

The name of the issue, Our Bad, is taken from Williams's essay, "Acid Doubt," which finds promise in a particular effect of sabotage: the paranoia that plagues bosses when they realize that every breakdown, every "accident," might be a sign of conspiracy among

workers. While sabotage has come to be associated with individual deviance, we want to emphasize the force of coordinated action and the utility of provoking suspicion, as well as the reanimating energy of craftiness and wit. To go back to the history: after the Scottish dockworkers' strike was broken, they refused to walk away or accept lower wages. Instead, they highlighted the value of their own skills by playfully miming the shoddy work of scabs. Eventually, their bosses offered the requested two-cent raise. In addition to wreckage or a wrench in a gear, sabotage can look like this: the realization of a quiet, potent collectivity that carves agency out of drudgery and offers a shared thrill—if not always a raise—in the face of defeat.



Sabotage means to push back,
pull out or break off the
fangs of Capitalism

W. D. Haywood

Credits

The interstitial images in this essay are from a collection of stickers, known as “stickerettes” or “silent agitators,” produced by the Industrial Workers of the World between 1910 and 1920.

“A Note on Our Bad” is part of Our Bad, an issue of Triple Canopy on the possibilities of sabotage, from spectacular acts and mischievous disruptions to subtle subversions and collective plots. Our Bad is made possible through the generous support of the Lambent Foundation/Fund of Tides Foundation; Critical Minded, an initiative to invest in cultural critics of color cofounded by the Nathan Cummings Foundation and the Ford Foundation; the Andy Warhol Foundation for the Visual Arts; the Horace W. Goldsmith Foundation; the Chauncey and Marion D. McCormick Family Foundation; the Ken & Judith Joy Family Foundation; the National Endowment for the Arts; the New York State Council on the Arts with the support of the Office of the Governor and the New York State Legislature; the New York City Department of Cultural Affairs in partnership with the City Council; Amazon Literary Partnership Literary Magazine Fund and the Community of Literary Magazines & Presses; the Stolbun Family; and Triple Canopy’s Director’s and Publishers Circles.

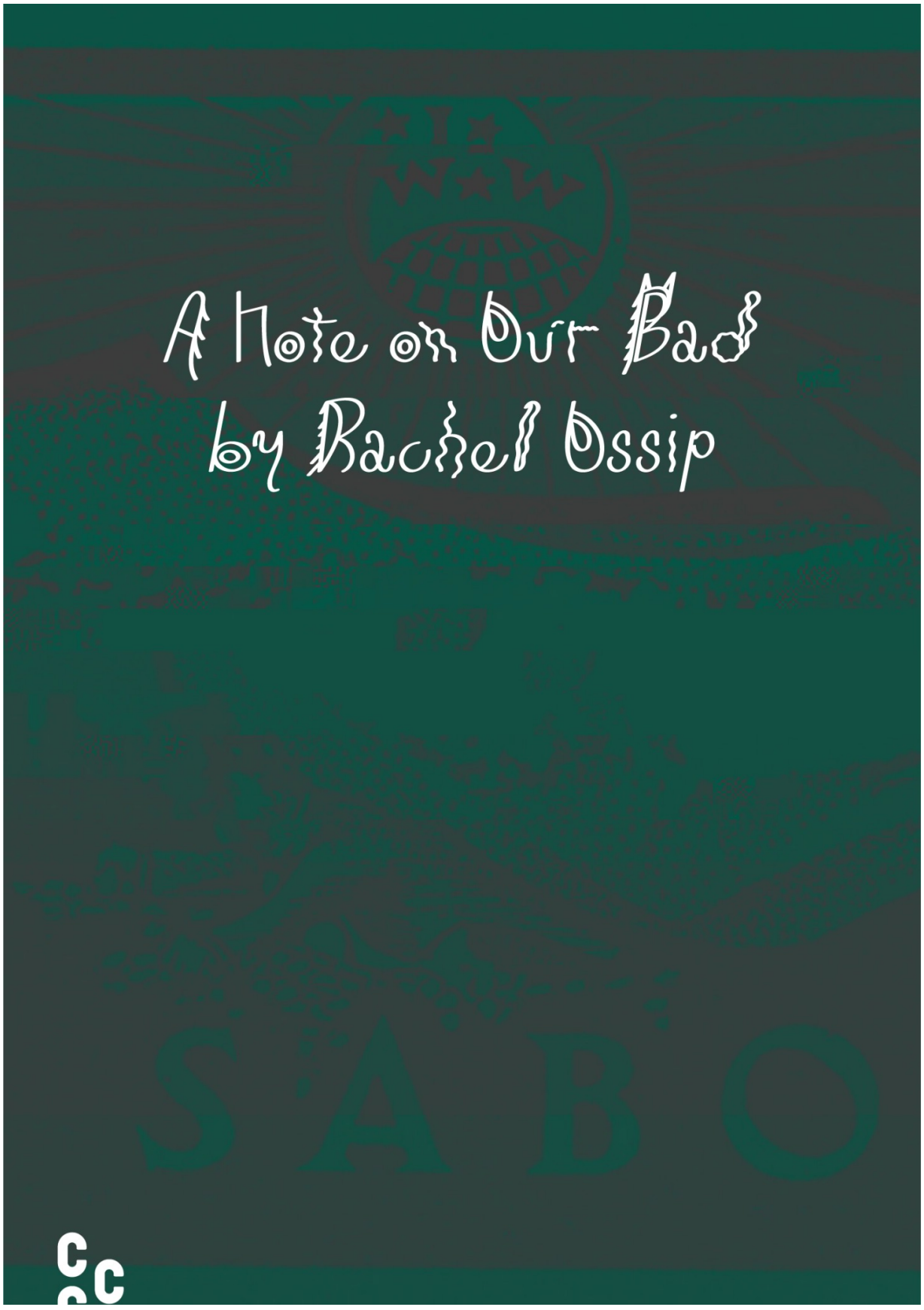
The title-page type, Third World Gay Revolution, was created for Our Bad by the designer Nat Pyper. The font is named after a collective of Black and Latinx activists that spun off from the Gay Liberation Front in 1970, and based on letterforms designed by Juan Carlos Vidal for the group’s “16 Point Platform and Program,” published in the radical gay newspaper *Come Out!* Third World Gay Revolution is part of Pyper’s series A Queer Year of Love Letters, downloadable for free via Library Stack.

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by Rachel Ossip





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1. In contrast, the US Department of Homeland Security seems to hold that sabotage is a somewhat lesser evil, conjoining "Sabotage / Tampering / Vandalism" as one item on a list of forms of "Suspicious Activity." The trio is, together, defined as "damaging or destroying part of a facility, infrastructure, or secured site." Another form of "Suspicious Activity" is "Photography."↵

I 29 Introduction 2 Chapter

1. For an in-depth analysis of these debates within the Socialist Party of America, as well as a rigorous history of sabotage's role within the I.W.W., see R.H. Lossin's "The Point of Destruction: Sabotage, Speech, and Progressive-Era Politics," (PhD diss., Columbia University, 2020).↵